Anusree Vishnu, *30*

Thiruvananthapuram

CA student, part-time accountant

Constituency: Thiruvananthapuram

Issues that will decide her vote: How parties treat women, candidate's track record

Demands from the govt: More jobs for women, ensure women's safety, reduce gender gap

Teach Your Girl Children Well

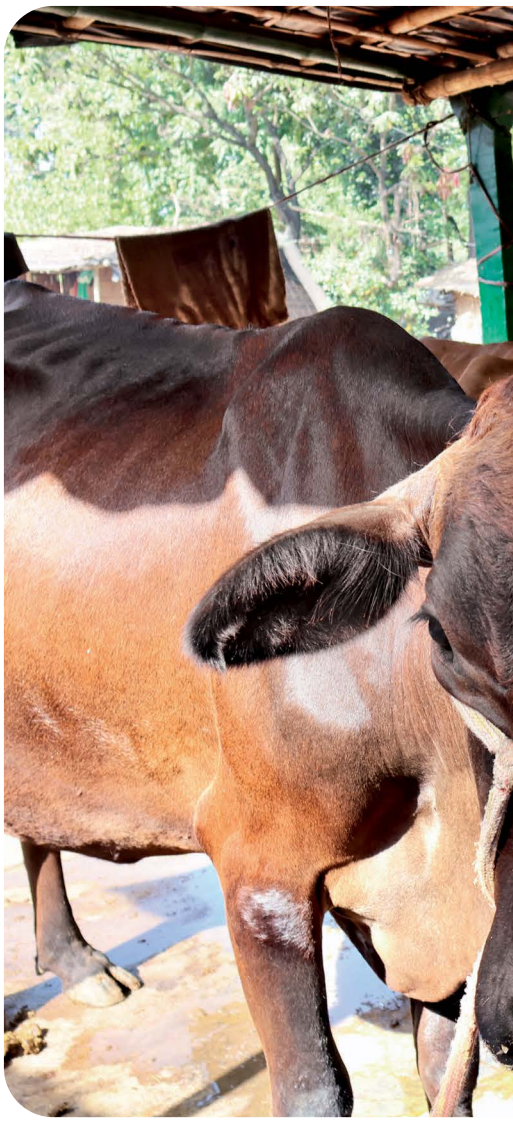
Coming from a state that has the highest female literacy rate in the country, it's natural for Anusree to push for girl's education at the pan-India level. "All governments," she says, "must give priority to educate girls up to at least Class 12, and offer special scholarships for higher education to those belonging to poor families." For this, she suggests, the government should adopt gender budgeting—a strategy to achieve equality between women and men by focusing on how public resources are collected and spent—and double the allocation for women.

"It's only through education that women's empowerment can become a reality," adds Anusree. "We need more freedom at home, at the workplace and in public spaces." Women's safety remains a key concern for her; she feels it's becoming increasingly difficult for women to commute alone, especially at late hours. ■

–Jeemon Jacob



VIVEK R NAIR



Feeling the Pinch

A 'Class-8 pass' who has also been her village *mukhiya* for 10 years (2006-16), Reena Kumari comes from a financially stable family—her husband, Umesh Rai, is a farmer who also runs a successful dairy business. Yet, she is convinced that rising inflation has posed new challenges for every household, including hers. Managing expenses within a limited budget and also save money for exigencies has become particularly arduous. A mother of three, the eldest of whom—a daughter—is married, Reena is worried about the future of her two sons. The elder, 23, is assist-